MORE THAN PLAY

Recommendation Letter for Aarav Jain

As the Founder of the Khelo Tennis India Foundation and the More Than Play program, I have had the privilege of working with many young volunteers committed to education and community development. Among them, Aarav Jain, currently a Grade 11 student at Step by Step School, Noida, stands out as a thoughtful, dependable, and purpose-driven young leader.

I first interacted with Aarav in early 2025, when he reached out with a clear intention to design a science education program for children across our community centres. What immediately impressed me was his maturity, commitment, and preparedness. Through several on-site visits to our community centres, Aarav studied our context, identified learning gaps, and proposed a model that emphasised hands-on learning, practical application, continuity and long-term impact rather than isolated activities.

Between early 2025 and mid-2025, Aarav conducted a series of hands-on experiments to explain aerodynamics, day and night, the water cycle, buoyancy, and pressure differences across multiple sessions, reaching more than 50 students.

A key milestone of Aarav's engagement was the Science Exhibition on 16 November 2025 at our Nizamuddin Community Centre, which he organised with his batchmate. Planned and executed entirely by the two of them, the event brought together nearly 200 students from Ali Village, Sarai Kale Khan, Vasant Vihar, and Nizamuddin. Aarav prepared bilingual posters and quizzes to reinforce key science concepts. The science exhibition enabled students to conduct hands-on experiments that taught them concepts such as electrical circuits, chemical changes, the human torso, and Newton's law of gravity. He demonstrated an intuitive ability to make abstract concepts, such as projectile motion, more relatable through games like basketball, using a community field as an open classroom. For many students with limited exposure to formal science tools, this approach made scientific concepts both accessible and engaging.

Aarav's most significant contribution was the mentor-mentee system he established. Recognising that sustained change must come from within the community, he selected and trained 16 student leaders instead of positioning himself as the primary instructor. Through two intensive four-hour training sessions, he broke down scientific concepts, assigned practice tasks, monitored progress, and created an atmosphere where these young leaders could gain confidence. Their transformation was remarkable. By the end of the cycle, they were independently conducting experiments, explaining complicated scientific concepts and addressing questions, a testament to Aarav's patient mentorship and his focus on building a self-sustainable program. His careful coordination of logistics, volunteers, and a zero-plastic policy reflected a level of responsibility uncommon for someone of his age.

What stands out most is the growth Aarav enabled in others. The student leaders, many of whom began hesitant and unsure about scientific vocabulary, evolved into confident demonstrators who could explain, teach, and solve problems. This boost in self-belief is one of the most meaningful outcomes in community-driven education, and Aarav played a central role in creating it.

Throughout his time with us, Aarav demonstrated consistency, humility, and a strong work ethic. He communicated clearly with our team, planned meticulously, and developed systems, training modules, instructional videos, concept boards, and structured experiment guides that continue to serve our centres. His work reflects a thoughtful blend of empathy, structure, and vision.

Given his leadership, reliability, and measurable impact, I strongly recommend Aarav Jain for any academic opportunity he pursues. He has been an invaluable contributor to our initiative and has emerged as a young community leader whose influence will only continue to grow.

Sincerely,



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